Mohanad Barakat

AI Engineer & Founder | Ex-xAI Human Data Lead (Grok) | Agents, Evals & AI Products for MENA

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SUMMARY

AI engineer and founder with hands-on frontier-model data experience. Worked as **Human Data Lead on Grok at xAI** (Apr 2025 – Jan 2026) on pre-training, SFT and RLHF data, after nearly two years evaluating and ranking LLM outputs as an AI Trainer at Outlier. Founder of **MBAI Group** (Cairo & Dubai), where I build Arabic-first AI products end to end: a live AI travel guide that cites a dated source for every answer (TUT), an AI lead-generation and funnel SaaS (AutoLeadss), and an Egyptian storefront builder (Ibni), all designed to run on one shared model gateway tuned for Egyptian Franco-Arabic. I also built and run a multi-agent automation system for outreach, research and delivery. I was the youngest person on my team at xAI, and I am a contender in the GEF and EIP programs. Looking for junior-to-mid AI Engineer, Forward-Deployed Engineer, AI Product and Human Data roles. Works in Arabic, English, French and Hungarian.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & AI Engineer | MBAI Group (MB AI Solutions) **Oct 2025 – Present**
Cairo, Egypt & Dubai, UAE · AI product studio running its own ventures

- Founded an AI product studio and built its venture portfolio (AutoLeadss, TUT, Ibni, Virlo, Be3ly). Three products are live on their own domains: https://tutapp.co, https://autoleadss.com and https://ibni.app.
- Architected the **MBAI ecosystem**: one Clerk auth contract across 4 apps, one Neon Postgres database with a schema per app and a shared usage ledger, and the **MBAI AI gateway** (/v1/chat routing across Together AI and Anthropic, per-app bearer keys, usage ledger, Clerk webhook, hermetic tests), so apps never hold provider keys.
- Set up **mbai-franco**, a Gemma-3-4B model configuration with an injected Egyptian Franco-Arabic (Arabizi) prompt pack served through the gateway, and prepared a LoRA fine-tune and eval pipeline for a later stage.
- Shipped with test-gated, adversarial review: a planner model specs each build, delegated agents implement it, and an independent reviewer verifies it. Results include **186 automated tests** in Virlo Studio, a CI "margin-guard" that enforces at least 3.3x markup on every paid model call, and a cross-repo defect-class registry for bugs found in one product and swept from the others.
- Built bilingual, RTL-first Arabic/English (plus Franco) interfaces across products and handled payments integration (Paymob, Stripe), SEO/GEO foundations (sitemaps, llms.txt, JSON-LD) and Vercel deployments.

Human Data Lead (AI Pre- & Post-Training) | xAI (Grok) **Apr 2025 – Jan 2026**
Remote from Cairo, Egypt

- Worked on human data for Grok across pre-training, supervised fine-tuning (**SFT**) and **RLHF**; in the first three months alone, contributed to **10+ projects**, with much of that time on the Deep Search project.
- Designed evaluation rubrics and annotation guidelines that defined good Grok output for reasoning, factuality and coding tasks, and ran quality review and calibration so consistent data reached training.
- Met productivity benchmarks and exceeded them on multiple projects. QA scores and lead times on most projects were at least the team average and often above it (manager's 3- and 6-month review).
- Youngest person on my team at xAI.
- Worked largely on my own with about 1.5 hours of daily overlap with a US-based manager. Proposed workflow improvements and answered colleagues' questions in team channels.

  Recognition: *"Mohanad regularly meets productivity benchmarks and has exceeded them on multiple projects."* · *"His efforts to elevate both his contributions and the broader quality of our data make him a valued member of the xAI team."* (xAI manager, 3- and 6-month review)

AI Trainer (LLM Evaluation) | Outlier AI **Jul 2023 – Mar 2025**
Remote, Egypt

- Evaluated and ranked LLM responses for truthfulness, factuality, coherence, relevance, fluency and completeness, producing preference data for model training.
- Categorized errors and biases (factual inaccuracies, logical fallacies, stylistic issues) and wrote written feedback to guide model improvement.

AI Trainer (Evaluation, Contract) | Alignerr (Labelbox) **Oct 2025 – Nov 2025**
Remote, Egypt

- Onboarded onto model evaluation projects on the Labelbox platform, including function-calling and video function-calling evaluation.

Real Estate Sales Agent | Elements Real Estate **Jan 2023 – Jun 2023**
Egypt

- Handled inbound buyer, seller and renter inquiries about listings, pricing, property features and neighborhoods. This client-facing experience now shapes how I scope AI tools for real-estate clients at AutoLeadss.

FOUNDER PROJECTS / PRODUCTS

TUT: Egypt boarding pass + sourced AI guide | https://tutapp.co | Live

- Built a tourist PWA that installs without an app store. Its AI guide answers prices, opening hours, visas, SIMs and emergency numbers from a sourced knowledge base, cites the publisher and the date each source was checked, and says so when no source exists.
- The guide answers in 12 languages, Egyptian Arabic and Franco-Arabic included. Visitors get a free check-in boarding pass with their name in hieroglyphs and "Pharaoh Me" portraits. Stack: Next.js 15, Clerk, Prisma, gateway-based model router.

AutoLeadss: AI lead-generation agency + self-serve funnel-builder SaaS | https://autoleadss.com | Live

- Built a bilingual EN/AR (RTL) agency site and an 8-phase funnel-builder SaaS (React, Vite, TypeScript), demo-mode first with each feature switched on by environment keys. It includes streaming AI funnel generation with a model router, Clerk auth with Supabase RLS, Stripe/Paymob checkout, a WhatsApp Cloud API webhook bot (Gemma for chat, Claude for copy), custom domains, white-label sub-accounts and analytics.

Ibni: Egyptian storefront builder | https://ibni.app | Demo live

- Built a trilingual (Arabic, Franco, English), RTL-first Next.js 15 app in strict TypeScript. The agent streams typed events over SSE, with a Sandpack live preview, a Paymob checkout with a verify-first idempotent SHA-512 webhook, Prisma and Clerk, and 36 passing tests. Later pivoted it from an AI app builder to a storefront builder for Egyptian small businesses.

ApexOne Knowledge Assistant: evidence-grounded RAG (hiring assessment) |
https://github.com/mohanadbarakattt/apexone-knowledge-assistant

- Built a local Python employee knowledge assistant that checks permissions before search, verifies every claim and citation against authorized sources, and declines safely when it cannot support an answer. It passes **10 of 10** assessment cases and **98 automated tests**.

Virlo Studio: Egyptian-first AI image & video generation studio | Demo; venture since pivoted

- Built a culture engine with Franco-Arabic transliteration, keyword-overlap retrieval for cultural context and steering guardrails. Also built a credit ledger with queue and retry logic, plus 17 Egyptian presets. Next.js 15, Drizzle, PGlite, Vitest.

AI AUTOMATION SYSTEMS

- Built and run a **multi-agent automation system** on Grok Bot: a team of specialized AI assistants (Career Manager, AutoLeadss Ads, SEO & AEO Desk, TUT, ClaudeFleet, CodeQuest) that run scheduled routines, browser automation and multi-channel outreach, with human approval before anything high-stakes goes out.
- Designed a weekday outreach pipeline: morning (09:30) and afternoon (15:30) runs research roles, send verified emails, apply on LinkedIn and draft X replies, then email a digest. Everything is logged to a CSV tracker, which holds **578 entries across 386 organizations** (Sep – Oct 2026).
- Automated TUT operator and investor outreach with guardrails: daily send ceilings, a never-invent-an-address rule, a halt when bounces cluster, and a reply triage agent that drafts responses and escalates legal or term-sheet threads to me.
- Built **claude-hq** (https://github.com/mohanadbarakattt/claude-hq), a zero-dependency Python toolkit for agentic coding. It has a usage dashboard, cross-session memory search, digests compiled into a start-of-session briefing, planner/executor/reviewer agents on cheaper models, an "AI Council" that sends one prompt to several models in parallel, and a 10-minute autopilot. Also published an open-source Grok counterpart, grok-hq.

EDUCATION

BSc Information Management | NOVA IMS, Universidade Nova de Lisboa (Egypt campus) **Sep 2024 – Present**

- Course projects: FitLife smartwatch data (Python preprocessing of 10,000 activity records into a 500-user analytic base table, 3×IQR outlier rule removing 0.04% of rows, K-means with k=3 chosen by silhouette score, Power BI). Multivariate analysis of education, governance and safety in MENA 2008–2018 (group leader; PCA, factor analysis, clustering). Econometrics study of human capital and GDP growth across 86 countries (World Bank data, 2000–2020). Information Systems strategy for a ride-hailing company.
- Leadership: organizer of the university expo (NOVA EXPO 2026), Head of Media, and technical lead on technical course projects, all while studying full time.

Foundation Program, Mechatronics Engineering | University of Debrecen, Hungary **Sep 2019 – Jul 2020**

American High School Diploma (NEASC) | Al Mawakeb School, Dubai, UAE **Sep 2013 – Jun 2018**

PROGRAMS

- **Contender** in the GEF and EIP programs

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AI for Finance**, AMIT Learning, Jan 2026. Project-based: AI agents for financial workflows and LLM-driven reporting automation.
- **CS50's Introduction to Programming with Python**, HarvardX (edX), Dec 2023
- **CS50's Web Programming with Python and JavaScript**, HarvardX (edX), Nov 2023

SKILLS

LLM & AI: LLM evaluation, rubric and guideline design, SFT and RLHF data, preference ranking, annotation QA and calibration, prompt engineering, RAG with citation verification, AI agents, multi-agent orchestration, function-calling evaluation, model routing and AI gateways, Arabic and Franco-Arabic NLP

Models & APIs: Anthropic Claude, OpenAI, Google Gemini, Grok, Together AI, Groq, Gemma, DeepSeek/OpenRouter, ElevenLabs (TTS), WhatsApp Cloud API

Engineering: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js, React, Vite, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Prisma, Drizzle, PostgreSQL (Neon, Supabase, PGlite), Supabase Edge Functions, Clerk, REST, SSE, webhooks, Stripe, Paymob, PWAs, Vitest, pytest, Git/GitHub, Vercel, browser automation

Data: Data preprocessing, K-means clustering, PCA, factor analysis, econometrics, Power BI, SAS, R

Product: 0-to-1 product development, discovery and scoping, pricing and margin guardrails, bilingual RTL UX, B2B outreach and GTM, client-facing delivery

LANGUAGES

Arabic (native) · English (C1, professional) · French (B1–B2) · Hungarian (B1)

LINKS

Portfolio: https://mbai-group.com
LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/mohanad-barakat-4b8a9b109
GitHub: https://github.com/mohanadbarakattt
X: https://x.com/Mobar001
TUT: https://tutapp.co
AutoLeadss: https://autoleadss.com
Ibni: https://ibni.app